



Antigua & Barbuda

A former colony of Spain, France, and the UK, Antigua and Barbuda lies at the outer edge of the Leeward Islands group in the Caribbean, and includes the uninhabited islet of Redonda.



GEOGRAPHY

Mainly low-lying limestone and coral islands with some higher volcanic areas. Antigua's coast is indented with bays and harbors.



CLIMATE

Tropical, moderated by trade winds and sea breezes. Humidity and rainfall are low for the region.



PEOPLE & SOCIETY

Population almost entirely of African origin, with small communities of Europeans and South Asians. Women's status has risen as a result of greater access to education. Wealth disparities are small. The Bird family dominated politics from 1960, but lost power to the United Progressive Party (UPP) from 2004.



INSIGHT: In 1865, Redonda was "claimed" by an eccentric Englishman as a kingdom for his son



THE ECONOMY

Tourism is the main source of revenue and the biggest provider of jobs. Financial services and Internet gambling are expanding. High debt.



FACTFILE

OFFICIAL NAME: Antigua and Barbuda

DATE OF FORMATION: 1981

CAPITAL: St. John's

POPULATION: 82,800

TOTAL AREA: 170 sq. miles

(442 sq. km)

DENSITY: 487 people per sq. mile

LANGUAGES: English*, English patois

RELIGIONS: Anglican 45%, other Protestant 42%, Roman Catholic 10%, other 2%, Rastafarian 1%

ETHNIC MIX: Black African 95%, other 5%

GOVERNMENT: Parliamentary system

CURRENCY: E. Caribbean \$ = 100 cents